ZiHan Chen

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EDUCATION

The Chinese University of HongKong (Shenzhen) **ShenZhen, China**
BA English Studies (Stream: International Corporate Communication) ***Sept. 2022 – Expected May 2026***

- *Grade:* 3.0/4
- *Core Courses:* English Linguistics, Grammatical Analysis, Language and Society, Genre Analysis, Intercultural Communication, Language and Media, Analytical Writing

The University of Queensland **Australia**
Exchange Programme ***Jul. 2024 – Nov. 2024***

- *Core Courses:* Introduction to Chinese–English Translation, Intercultural Communication, Spoken Korean IA, Language & Society

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCES

Exploring the Rhetorical and Linguistic Strategies of Startup Crowdfunding Texts: A Comparative Genre Analysis of Kickstarter and Indiegogo. ***May 2025***

- Conducted a qualitative comparative genre analysis of crowdfunding campaign texts on Kickstarter and Indiegogo, drawing on Swales (1990) move analysis and Bhatia (1993) genre theory.
- Examined persuasive linguistic strategies across sections, including stance/appeals (ethos–pathos–logos), evidential support, second-person address, emotional vs technical lexis, and sentence-level style differences.
- Compared platform conventions, showing that Kickstarter texts foreground innovation with a more formal tone, while Indiegogo emphasizes user experience, emotional resonance, and community participation.

Examining the Use and Variability of "Yeah-No" in Australian English: Insights from Regional Linguistic Identity ***Aug. 2024***

- Investigated the discourse marker "yeah-no" in Australian English, focusing on its pragmatic functions and links to speaker identity and regional variation.
- Collected spoken data through a semi-structured interview with a 19-year-old regional Australian English speaker, then transcribed and coded the data to track the presence/absence of "yeah-no" and the use of alternative discourse markers (e.g., "not really," "however," "personally").
- Concluded that the participant preferred more explicit markers, suggesting that the use of "yeah-no" may vary by age, region, and individual interactional style, and that "iconic" AuE features may not be universal across speakers.

Chinese Students' Educational Choices: Influences from Educational Culture ***Aug. 2024***

- Examined how Chinese educational culture shapes students' values, identity, and decision-making about academic versus vocational pathways.
- Applied Dodd's cultural frameworks to analyze the interaction between cultural beliefs (Confucian heritage) and institutional structures in China's education system.
- Discussed policy and labor-market factors (e.g., employment pressures, skills shortages) to explain why academic routes are still seen as more prestigious than vocational training.

Pragmatic Competence of Chinese Second Language Learners ***May 2024***

- Investigated pragmatic competence in L2 use with focus on how sociocultural factors shape "appropriate" language choices in context.
- Synthesized core SLA and pragmatics frameworks, including Krashen's Input Hypothesis (i+1), Grice's Cooperative Principle, and politeness theories to interpret learner breakdowns.
- Conducted contextual review of English use and learning in China (policy/globalization/technology/pop culture) and compared features of China English with neighboring contexts (e.g., Japan/Korea) through historical and sociocultural factors.
- Analyzed representative cases (phonological transfer, idiom misuse, grammatical agreement, cultural etiquette norms) and proposed pedagogical interventions (contrastive awareness training, role-play practice, idiom glossaries, and culture instruction).

INTERNSHIP EXPERIENCE

删除[Author]: **Method:**

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删除[Author]: **Limitation:** The study relied on a single participant and one elicitation setting; future work should include more diverse sample (age/gender/region) and more context-specific prompts to capture low-frequency discourse markers in natural interaction.

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Yucai No. 2 Primary School, Shekou Yucai Education Group **Shenzhen, China**

Teaching Intern ***Dec. 2025 – Jan. 2026***

- Completed 15 classroom observations and evaluations, documenting teaching approaches and classroom management across different year groups.
- Delivered two weeks of independent teaching for two Grade 4 classes, conducted termly revision and managed pre-/post-class marking and student Q&A sessions.
- Joined early-career teacher professional development sessions, exchanging practical strategies, and addressing common classroom challenges with peer English teachers.

Shenzhen Longhua Foreign Languages Senior High School **Shenzhen, China**

Teaching Intern ***Sept. 2025 – Oct. 2025***

- Completed 25 classroom observations and evaluations; analyzed teaching strategies, interaction patterns, and management techniques across grade levels and produced observation reports.
- Supported teachers by facilitating classroom activities, answering student questions, and providing after-class tutoring.
- Participated in subject-group teaching and research meetings, contributing to discussions on curriculum planning and current trends in secondary English teaching.

Shanghai Foreign Language School Affiliated to Longgang (Primary School) **Shenzhen, China**

Teaching Intern ***May 2025 – Jul. 2025***

- Designed and delivered English club lessons independently, applying gamified and role-play activities;
- Marked daily assignments and provided individualized feedback; identified recurring learning problems and supported classroom management and after-class Q&A.
- Co-organized the school International Culture Festival

SKILLS AND OTHERS

- Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native); English (proficient); Korean (good).
- Technical skills: Microsoft Office (Word formatting/document layout; PowerPoint teaching materials design; Excel data organization/analysis).
- Campus Experience:
  - As the event organizer and Chinese–English bilingual host for CUHK-Shenzhen's Intercultural Exchange Event, I independently planned and ran a booth (activity design, venue setup, and on-site coordination) and introduced Chinese traditions to international students.
  - As a Library Assistant at CUHK-Shenzhen's University Library, I supported daily operations by handling book loans/returns, shelving, and assisting students with enquiries.

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